KEEPING IT REAL

20.8% OF LISTINGS JUST CUT PRICE.

The highest September reading on record.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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MORE INVENTORY. MORE PRICE CUTS. PENDING SALES JUST FELL FOR THE SECOND MONTH STRAIGHT.

Realtor.com's September report: active listings are now within 9.1% of pre-pandemic levels, the closest in this entire recovery.

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SELLERS AREN'T CUTTING PRICE BECAUSE THEY GOT UNLUCKY.

Realtor.com's September 2026 housing report, from chief economist Danielle Hale and senior economist Jake Krimmel: 20.8% of active listings had a price reduction, up 0.9 points from a year ago and the highest September share on record. Active inventory rose 5.4% year over year to over 1,161,000 homes, closing the gap to pre-pandemic inventory to 9.1%. Homes going under contract fell 4.1% year over year, the steepest annual drop since March 2025. Every seller in a given neighborhood got more competition at the same time rates above 7% thinned the buyer pool. That's a market condition, not a pricing mistake, and it changes what the listing conversation has to cover this month.

WHAT YOU DO DIFFERENTLY THIS MONTH:

1 **Launch at the number that survives the first two weeks.**

With one in five listings already cutting, a seller who tests high this month joins that number instead of staying out of it.

2 **Show the seller the competing inventory, not just the comps.**

Comps are closed sales. Competing inventory is what a buyer is cross-shopping today, and there's 5.4% more of it than a year ago.

3 **Build the pre-launch plan before the sign goes in the yard.**

Photos, staging, and the first two weeks of marketing matter more with more listings fighting for the same buyer pool.

4 **Lead with the pending-sales drop, not the listing count.**

Pending sales fell for the second straight month. That's the buyer-side half of the story a seller needs before they pick a number.

THE TAKEAWAY

PULL YOUR AREA'S ACTIVE LISTING COUNT BEFORE YOUR NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT.

One in five sellers nationally already had to cut. Walk in already knowing why.

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